

Francis IT - Tech Doc

HP_System_Remediation.pdf | May 2026 | Jami@FrancisIT.com | 619-500-9980

Project: Malware Removal & Performance Tuning (HP All-in-One)

1. Phase I: Pre-Remediation & Licensing

Before beginning the automated cleaning process, critical licensing data must be secured to ensure the client's paid subscriptions are preserved.

Verify McAfee Subscription

- Open the McAfee interface.
- Navigate to Account > My Subscription.
- Action: Document the registered email address. Modern McAfee licenses are entitlement-based rather than utilizing a local 25-digit key.

Verify Cloud Connectivity

Ensure the PC is online. Perform the standard Windows "Uninstall a Program" for McAfee. This allows the software to ping McAfee servers and "release" the license seat for later reinstallation.

DEEP CLEANUP

Run the McAfee Consumer Product Removal (MCPR) tool to strip remaining kernel-level drivers and registry hooks that interfere with deep-system scanning.

2. Phase II: Tron Script Configuration

Due to the hardware constraints of an older HP AIO with 8GB RAM and a mechanical HDD, the Tron script must be customized.

Download the full version of Tron here: <https://bmr.org/repos/tron>

Command Line Command: `tron.bat -a -sd -p`

Switch Definitions:

- -a (Automatic): Skips the manual "I AGREE" disclaimer and proceeds through stages without prompts.
- -sd (Skip Defrag): Mandatory for this unit; a full defrag on mechanical HDDs with poor thermals can lead to overheating and adds 4+ hours to runtime.

- -p (Preserve Power): Prevents the HP system from entering Sleep or Hibernation mode.

3. Phase III: Execution & Stages

- Preparation: Reboot the PC before launching. Ensure no Windows Updates are pending.
- Launch: Open an Elevated Command Prompt (Admin), navigate to the Tron folder, and execute the command string.
- Stage 3 (Disinfect): Malwarebytes will install and open a window. Tron will continue other scans (Sophos/Kaspersky) in the background. Note: You may manually click "Scan" in the Malwarebytes window when convenient, but the rest of the script proceeds regardless.

4. Phase IV: Final Optimization & Post-Clean

Manual steps to ensure "Fake Virus" pop-ups do not return:

1. Browser Notification Reset: Open Chrome/Edge settings, navigate to Privacy and Security > Site Settings > Notifications, and remove any unrecognized URLs in the "Allow" list.
2. Reinstall Security Software: Navigate to home.mcafee.com, log in using the email address recorded in Phase I, and run the installer. The subscription auto-activates based on hardware ID and account login.
3. Thermal Verification: Ensure the rear vents are clear of dust; mechanical drives are prone to failure during high-intensity scans in restricted airflow.

Data Preservation & Browser Integrity

Important: The process will not remove favorites (bookmarks) from Chrome or Edge.

- Stage 1 (Tempclean): Tron wipes temporary files, cookies, and browsing history to remove tracking files used by "fake pop-up" scripts.
- What is Safe: Favorites, Bookmarks, and Saved Passwords are stored in separate database files and are ignored by Tron.

Summary of Data Changes:

- Removed: Browsing History, Cookies, Cache, and Malicious Notifications.
- Preserved: Bookmarks, Favorites, and Saved Passwords.